# Activity 2: DBS: Translate 'Live more, Bank less' into Business Value

Objective: Demonstrate appreciation of a service brand and its competitive advantage
Expected output: Promise-to-impact logic model and 250-word management narrative Primary source: https://www.dbs.com/about-us/who-we-are/our-promise-to-you

## Goal

Use DBS's public brand promise to trace how a promise can influence customer experience and business outcomes.

## Real-world scenario

DBS states that its brand promise is 'Live more, Bank less' and describes making banking simple and effortless so customers can spend more time on what matters.

A regional business bank wants to learn from the logic of DBS's promise without copying its words. The bank must identify a customer outcome it can credibly own and show how delivery would create value.

## Evidence boundary

Public case facts and fictional learner data must never be mixed. Every numerical or organisational training input is labelled as an assumption.

### Training assumptions / guardrails

- The regional bank and performance data are fictional; no DBS operating metrics are supplied or inferred.
- Small-business customers report repeated-document requests, slow onboarding and unclear case ownership.
- Management defines success as lower customer effort and faster time to first value, subject to compliance controls.
- The team may redesign one journey but cannot replace the core banking platform this quarter.

## Questions

1. What customer outcome makes the DBS promise relevant rather than merely memorable?
2. Which service capabilities would be required to make a comparable promise credible?
3. How could improved delivery affect trust, retention, referral and cost-to-serve?
4. Which alternative explanations must be considered before claiming business impact?

## Detailed activity procedure

### Step 1: Interpret the promise

Identify the audience, desired progress, emotional benefit and implied service standard in the public DBS statement.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

### Step 2: Diagnose the fictional journey

Map onboarding friction, customer effort, handoffs, delays and moments of uncertainty.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

### Step 3: Choose a differentiated outcome

Write an original promise for the regional bank that is relevant, distinctive and operationally deliverable.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

### Step 4: Build the logic model

Connect capabilities to service behaviours, customer responses and commercial outcomes; mark each link as hypothesis or evidence.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

### Step 5: Stress-test credibility

Identify compliance, technology, channel and employee constraints that could break the promise.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

### Step 6: Draft the management narrative

Explain the competitive advantage, expected benefits, risk, first experiment and evidence threshold for scaling.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

## Deliverable

Promise-to-impact logic model and 250-word management narrative

## Acceptance criteria

The logic model contains capability, delivery, customer and business layers; every causal claim is labelled; and the proposed promise is original, relevant and deliverable.

## Reflection and debrief questions

1. Which customer or employee insight changed your recommendation most, and why?
2. What evidence would you request before investing or scaling?
3. Which stakeholder owns the next service-brand decision?
4. What should the organisation start, stop or continue?

## Facilitator debrief

Compare recommendations against relevance, distinctiveness, deliverability and evidence quality. Surface unsupported causal claims. Close by naming one decision, one owner and one validation action.

## Source note

Source accessed 17 August 2026: https://www.dbs.com/about-us/who-we-are/our-promise-to-you